

AFL Data Dictionary & Target Definitions

Dataset Summary

Dataset	Unit of Analysis	Purpose
cleaned_round_by_round_stats_v2.csv	One player per match	Player-level performance analysis and player prediction.
cleaned_team_matches.csv	One team per match	Match outcome prediction and team-level analysis.
cleaned_seasonal_stats.csv	One player per season	Historical player summaries and feature enrichment.

Key Variables

Variable	Description
player_id	Unique player identifier
team	Team represented by the player or match
opponent	Opposing team
match_date	Match date
year	AFL season
round	Competition round
result	Match outcome (Win/Loss/Draw)
goals	Goals scored
kicks	Total kicks
handballs	Total handballs
disposals	Kicks + handballs
fantasy_points	Overall fantasy performance score
margin	Winning margin in points

Prediction Targets

Target	Problem Type	Definition
Match Winner	Binary Classification	Predict whether a team wins or loses a match.
Top Goal Kicker	Ranking	Player with the most goals in a match.
Top Disposal Getter	Ranking	Player with the highest disposals in a match.
Fantasy Points Leader	Ranking	Player with the highest fantasy points in a match.
Match Margin (Secondary)	Regression	Predict the point difference between teams.

Engineered Features

- Rolling averages (last 3 and 5 matches) for goals, disposals and fantasy points
- Career progress
- Days since previous match
- Season progress
- Team win streak
- Historical head-to-head win rate

All rolling features were calculated using only previous matches (*shift(1)*) to prevent data leakage.

Notes

- Negative values in **disposals**, **kicks**, and **handballs** were treated as invalid because these statistics cannot be negative.
- Negative **fantasy_points** were retained because fantasy scoring systems can legitimately assign negative scores.
- Weather, player position, travel distance, and ladder position were unavailable and therefore excluded from the feature set.